# CONSTITUTION AND BYLAWS OF ELIGIBLE LEAGUE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY ENTHUSIASTS (ELITE)

## (REVISED 2024)

# BY-LAWS AND CONSTITUTION

## Preamble

We, the students of the Polytechnic University of the Philippines Santa Rosa Campus, guided by our faith and acknowledging the support of our Almighty God, aim to establish a nationalist and democratic Eligible League of Information Technology Enthusiasts that shall accurately represent the needs, ideals, and aspirations of its studentry, safeguarding their rights and welfare while striving for academic excellence and freedom. ELITE aims to cultivate strong bonds between students, faculty, and the administration, fostering a sense of community. We are dedicated to promoting awareness and active involvement in the pursuit of a nationalist, scientific, and socially relevant education. In pursuit of these objectives, we hereby promulgate and amend their constitution.

## ARTICLE I
## NAME AND NATURE OF THE ORGANIZATION

***SECTION 1.*** The official union of the Polytechnic University of the Philippines Santa Rosa Campus shall be known as the Eligible League of Information Technology Enthusiasts (ELITE).

***SECTION 2.*** ELITE shall have jurisdiction over the entire population of IT students.

***SECTION 3.*** The logo and name of ELITE shall not be used for immoral purposes or in any unofficial documents without the organization's consent.

***SECTION 4.*** The logo

a. The logo of ELITE is the official emblem of the IT student of Polytechnic University of the Philippines Santa Rosa Campus.
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b. The logo of ELITE is strictly for official use only.

c. The color scheme and design symbolism of the ELITE logo are to remain unaltered by any additional images or designs, preserving its original integrity. It should be able to stand on its own when employed in official documents, posters, and related mediums.

***SECTION 5.*** The symbolism of the ELITE Organization logo

## ARTICLE II
## DECLARATION OF PRINCIPLES AND COUNCIL POLICIES

***SECTION 1.*** The Eligible League of Information Technology Enthusiasts is a nationalist and democratic student union. Sovereignty resides in the students and all ELITE authority emanates from them.

***SECTION 2.*** ELITE advocates for and promotes an education system that is free, scientific, and accessible to a wide audience.

***SECTION 3.*** The primary responsibility of ELITE is to safeguard and advance the rights, interests, and well-being of its members.

***SECTION 4.*** The core principle of the ELITE Organization is to cultivate a cohesive, united, and supportive community among its members, while also assisting the university in fulfilling its holistic goals for student success.

### ORGANIZATION POLICIES

***SECTION 1.*** ELITE shall proactively engage and provide support for both academic and non-academic activities within PUP SRC.

***SECTION 2.*** ELITE aims to foster a sense of civic responsibility and awareness of societal issues among its members. Through various initiatives and activities, members will be encouraged to engage with their communities, understand their roles as responsible student leaders, and uphold ethical standards in their actions.

***SECTION 3.*** ELITE shall promote and endorse the advancement of a culture rooted in nationalism, mass orientation, and scientific principles.

***SECTION 4.*** ELITE shall firmly advocate and defend the rights and welfare of individuals across all genders and age groups, through support initiatives and advocacy efforts, promoting equality and preventing discrimination.

***SECTION 5.*** ELITE shall consistently represent the student body within the school administration, faculty, and broader community.

***SECTION 6.*** ELITE shall place utmost importance on various facets of development, including education, science and technology, arts, culture, and sports.

***SECTION 7.*** ELITE shall guarantee equal access to opportunities for its members' services.

***SECTION 8.*** ELITE shall remain steadfast in its commitment to integrity and transparency while serving the student community and rigorously enforce measures to prevent and address any instances of misconduct or unethical conduct among its leadership.

***SECTION 9.*** ELITE shall adhere to a policy of complete public disclosure for all transactions related to student interests, including programs and financial statements.

## ARTICLE III
## ORGANIZATION'S DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

***SECTION 1.*** ELITE shall establish and enact rules and policies in alignment with the PUP Student Handbook, aiming to enhance the welfare of its members.

***SECTION 2.*** ELITE shall organize activities involving the students in support of the worthy projects of the university.

***SECTION 3.*** ELITE shall assist the school administration in planning and organizing the process of vital school celebrations.

***SECTION 4.*** ELITE shall:

a. Plan, approve, and implement programs and projects that are for the betterment of IT students; and
b. Post financial statement/s for every end of the semester and upon request of the director and the auditor.

# ARTICLE IV
# OFFICER'S DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

***SECTION 1.*** All ELITE Officers are accountable for the well-being of the entire IT student body.

***SECTION 2.*** All executive officers are required to participate in both major and minor activities and projects organized by ELITE.

***SECTION 3.*** It is both the right and duty of every officer and representative to attend regular or special meetings of the organization. While members have the privilege to attend, they may be temporarily suspended under exceptional circumstances.

***SECTION 4.*** All ELITE Officers are liable to undergo impeachment proceedings like any other executive officers.

***SECTION 5.*** The officers of the organization possess the right and duty to organize activities and programs for the welfare of its members, under Article IV Section 3

***SECTION 6.*** All officers, representatives, and members are obligated to adhere to and abide by their constitution and the by-laws established by the duly elected officers and representatives.

***SECTION 7.*** Duties and responsibilities of the executive department according to their positions:

PRESIDENT:

a. The executive power shall be vested in the ELITE president alone.
b. They shall be the official representative of the IT studentry of PUP-SRC to any event or organization.
c. They shall be the official representative alone of the University Board of Discipline.
d. They shall be responsible for promoting the institution's vision, mission, and philosophy to the whole IT studentry.
e. They shall promote worthy projects that are in the interest of the students.
f. They shall promote honesty and integrity in every dealing in and out of their jurisdiction.
g. They shall be the official officer speaker in any assembly concerning their leadership.
h. They shall have the right to approve and appoint officers as committee heads and members needed in case of events.
i. They shall have the power to nominate or to appoint any student to any branch of the ELITE Officers.
j. They shall not be eligible for re-election.

VICE PRESIDENT FOR INTERNAL AFFAIRS

a. In the absence of the ELITE President, they shall assume the position together with their (the president's) responsibilities and duties.
b. They shall work out every internal project of the council, including the review of by-laws.
c. They shall perform the duties assigned to them by the ELITE President.
d. They shall adhere to the responsibilities of a student leader.

VICE PRESIDENT FOR EXTERNAL AFFAIRS

a. In the absence of the ELITE President and VP for Internal Affairs, they shall assume the position together with their (the president's) responsibilities and duties.
b. They shall work out every external project of the organization.
c. They shall perform the duties assigned to them by the ELITE President.
d. They shall adhere to the responsibilities of a student leader.

EXECUTIVE SECRETARY

a. They shall be responsible for all the paperwork and announcements of the ELITE.
b. They shall perform the duties assigned to them by the ELITE President.
c. They shall be responsible for documenting and filing ELITE events, projects, and documents.
d. They shall be responsible for the minutes of the meeting.

DEPUTY SECRETARY

a. In the absence of the ELITE Executive Secretary, they shall assume the position together with their (the secretary's) responsibilities and duties.
b. They shall help the Executive Secretary with all the paperwork and announcements of the ELITE.
c. They shall perform the duties assigned to them by the ELITE President.

TREASURER

a. They shall be the official handler and the one responsible for the ELITE funds and treasury.
b. They shall be accountable for any loss or mishandling of the ELITE funds and treasury.
c. They shall submit the financial statement to the ELITE Auditor after every ELITE project and event.
d. They shall create a tabulation of expenses and report to ELITE officers at the end of the semester.
e. They shall perform the duties assigned to them by the ELITE President.

ASSISTANT TREASURER

a. In the absence of the ELITE Treasurer, they shall assume the position together with their (the secretary's) responsibilities and duties.
b. They shall help the Treasurer in handling the funds, creating financial statements, and tabulating expenses.
c. They shall be accountable for any loss or mishandling of the ELITE funds and treasury.
d. They shall create a tabulation of expenses and report to ELITE officers at the end of the semester.

e. They shall perform the duties assigned to them by the ELITE President.

AUDITOR

a. They shall supervise the handling, disbursing, and budgeting of the ELITE fund.
b. They shall audit the financial statement submitted by the ELITE Treasurer.
c. They shall present the audited financial statement to the ELITE President before verification.
d. They shall submit the audited financial statement to the administration office.
e. They shall perform the duties assigned to them by the ELITE President.

PIO

a. They shall be responsible for the information dissemination to the entire population of IT students.
b. They shall be an administrator of the official group of ELITE on Facebook and maintain the posts on that group.
c. They shall have contacts of all IT class presidents for information dissemination.
d. They are responsible for leading the Creatives Committee.
e. They shall perform the duties assigned to them by the ELITE President.

PROJECT MANAGER

a. They shall do follow-ups on all target dates.
b. They shall be responsible for the creation of forms and surveys for any activities related to the organization.
c. They are responsible for keeping and storing the organization's supplies.
d. They are responsible for leading the Programs Committee.
e. They shall perform duties assigned to them/them by the ELITE President and by their committee heads.

## ARTICLE V
## MEMBER'S DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

***SECTION 1.*** Each member must consistently adhere to the laws of the land, follow the rules and regulations of the university, and uphold the integrity of its constitution at all times

***SECTION 2.*** Each member is expected to contribute to creating an environment of academic excellence that fosters peace and harmony among all sectors of the university.

***SECTION 3.*** Every member must exercise their rights and fulfill their responsibilities while respecting the rights of their fellow students and other members of the PUP community.

***SECTION 4.*** It is the responsibility of every member to earnestly support all commendable projects undertaken by the organization.

***SECTION 5.*** Every member shall pay the membership fee defended by the Student Council Organization

## ARTICLE VI
## MEMBERS' RIGHTS

***SECTION 1.*** Members shall have the right to access information regarding matters that concern them.

***SECTION 2.*** Members are entitled to express their opinions and provide suggestions for the betterment of the organization.

***SECTION 3.*** Members are entitled to freedom of religious beliefs and faith.

***SECTION 4.*** Members shall have the right to conduct research, publish their findings, and engage in discussions regarding their recommendations, all in line with the principles of academic freedom.

***SECTION 5.*** Members have the right to utilize all available facilities and services provided by the university to the fullest extent

***SECTION 6.*** Members have the right to fair and just treatment in any situation involving them.

***SECTION 7.*** Members shall be protected from exploitation, harassment, cruelty, and unusual punishment

***SECTION 8.*** Members have the right to hold and express their ideological and political beliefs.

***SECTION 9.*** Members' communication and correspondence shall remain private and protected unless exceptional circumstances arise where the safety or order of the student body necessitates disclosure.

***SECTION 10.*** Members have the right to freedom of travel, which shall only be restricted in cases concerning the security, safety, and health of the students.

## ARTICLE VII
## STUDENTS' LEADERSHIP AND ENHANCEMENT TRAINING (SLET)

***SECTION 1.*** Potential members who will continue to serve the IT students selflessly shall be set to their leadership seminar.

# ARTICLE VIII

# ELECTIONS

***SECTION 1.*** The election process will be carried out by the IT student body of PUP-SRC.

***SECTION 2.*** The ELITE election will serve as the final event in the series of activities for the academic year.

***SECTION 3.*** The ELITE election will be facilitated by the former ELITE Officers.

***SECTION 4.*** Candidates running for election are prohibited from serving as a member of the ELITE elections committee.

***SECTION 5.*** Qualifications of the ELITE OFFICERS (for the elections)

a. Must be a member (student) according to Section 1 of Article II.
b. Must have an average of at least 2.25 from the previous or last semester with no failing grade (INC, Withdrawn, Drop) for the whole stay at the university.
c. Must have a good leadership status.
d. Must not be arranged with other organizations.
e. Should not have bad records with their instructors and schoolmates at the administration office.
f. Must not be forced or coerced by others to run for such a position.
g. Must not be a shiftee from other courses.

***SECTION 6.*** Qualifications as to office (positions)

PRESIDENT

a. They must not hold any position within PUP-SRC.
b. Must be willing to serve the students' welfare.
c. They are willing to participate in school programs and activities.
d. They must work willingly and harmoniously with the school administration.

VICE PRESIDENT FOR INTERNAL AFFAIRS

a. Have the same qualifications as the president.
b. They know how to deal with organizational relationships and organizational problems in the absence of the president.
c. They know how to hold meetings in the absence of the holding committee.
d. Must be knowledgeable in communication skills and know how to deal with programs for the studentry.

VICE PRESIDENT OF EXTERNAL AFFAIRS

a. Have the same qualifications as the president.
b. They know how to coordinate with their fellow vice president in cases of the president's absence or the holding committee's absence.
c. Must possess good communication skills and know how to deal with programs for the studentry.

EXECUTIVE SECRETARY

a. Must acquire technical-writing-related and communication subjects.
b. Must be flexible and willing to work on clerical tasks needed by the organization.
c. Must be ethical enough with regards to the security of the organization's files and the secrecy of meetings.

DEPUTY SECRETARY

a. Have the same qualifications as the secretary.
b. Must be willing to help the executive secretary in all the paperwork and clerical tasks assigned to them.

TREASURER

a. Must be willing to hold and secure the organization's fund and treasury.
b. Must be knowledgeable of basic financial accounting.
c. Must be willing to comply with the financial aspect of the organization.
d. Must have a strong sense of integrity in holding the organization's funds
e. Must be ethical enough in creating financial statements.

ASSISTANT TREASURER

a. Have the same qualifications as the treasurer
b. Must be willing to help the treasurer in holding and securing the organization's funds and treasury.
c. Must be willing to help in creating financial statements.

AUDITOR

a. Must be knowledgeable of basic financial accounting.
b. Must be willing to work hand-in-hand with the organization's treasury and the preparations of financial statements and transparency of reports.

PIO

a. Must be willing to adhere to and relate the organization's goals and mission to the students and for the students.
b. They must know how to communicate and keep information following the organization's discretion.
c. Must affirm to oneself the duty of creating and promoting peace among the members.

PROJECT MANAGER

a. Must be flexible and willing to work with the organization's projects and deal with the physical attributes in the work area.

b. Must have the leadership traits and trainee abilities to hold committees leading to harmonious work and related activities

***SECTION 7.*** The tenure of the former ELITE officers will extend until the final day of the academic year, while the new set of officers will assume their positions during the preparations for the following academic year. Their official oath-taking ceremony will typically occur in June, coinciding with the start of the new academic year.

***SECTION 8.*** The elected officers are required to make a courtesy call to the director either immediately after the election or within a week thereafter.

***SECTION 9.*** Resignation, Termination, and Vacancies.

RESIGNATION

a. All the elected officials as well as the members of the ELITE Committees may resign from their designated positions by filing a proper resignation letter.
b. The resigning officer must state the reason/s of their resignation. The reasons must be valid and acceptable.
c. The said officer must provide two copies of resignation letters addressed to the ELITE President and the ELITE Adviser.
d. In case the ELITE President is the one resigning, he must address the resignation letter to the ELITE adviser and the school administration.
e. The ELITE officers together with the ELITE adviser must meet and decide if they will approve the resignation of the said officer. Upon approval, the resigning officer will be officially excluded from the ELITE Organization.

TERMINATION

a. All the executive officials as well as members of the ELITE Organization Committees may be removed by impeachment on the ground of culpable violation of their constitution, and other appointed officials may be recalled from the office with just and reasonable cause upon orders of the appointing authority.
b. Any ELITE officer known to have illegal transactions is subject to suspension from office and endorsed to the university disciplinary board.
c. Any ELITE officer incurring three consecutive absences in ELITE meetings and assembly without prior notice or valid reasons shall be subjected to termination to be discussed by the ELITE President together with the other ELITE officers.
d. Any ELITE officers having an inappropriate attitude/behavior toward their co-officers, or university officials during meetings, and any official events handled by the ELITE shall be subjected to termination to be discussed by the ELITE president together with the other ELITE officers and committees.

VACANCIES

a. Whenever there is a vacancy in a position, the hierarchy of position shall be strictly followed. The lowest vacant position will be occupied by appointment (by the executive officers) or by-election.
b. The ELITE president shall have the power to nominate or appoint any student in any branch of the ELITE, such appointment needs further approval from the ELITE.

## ARTICLE IX
## CLASSROOM ASSEMBLY

***SECTION 1.*** The basic subdivision of ELITE shall be the classroom assembly.

***SECTION 2.*** The classroom assembly will consist of seven classroom officers: the class president, vice president, secretary, treasurer, auditor, public information officer, and project manager.

***SECTION 3.*** The duties and responsibilities of the classroom officers are the following:

PRESIDENT

a. They plan and implement a program of activities for the interest of their constituents.
b. They lead their constituents under their jurisdictions upon them.
c. They are the official representative of the classroom assembly to ELITE

VICE PRESIDENT

a. In the absence of the president, they will assume all the responsibilities of the class president.
b. They will be supporting the class president for the benefit of the whole class.

SECRETARY

a. They are the official encoder of the class.
b. They are the ones responsible for all the paperwork in the classroom assembly.
c. They are expected to submit to the class president (in the absence of the class president, it will be to the vice president) only for the benefit and interest of the classroom assembly.

TREASURER

a. They are the official handlers and are responsible for all the class funds and treasury.
b. They shall have a strong sense of integrity in handling the finances of the class.
c. They shall be accountable for any loss or mishandling of the class fund and treasury.

AUDITOR

a. They shall supervise the handling of class funds and treasury.
b. They shall audit the financial statement report of the classroom assembly.
c. They shall submit the financial report to the class president.

PIO

a. They shall be the official spokesperson of the class president.
b. They are responsible for coordinating with other affairs of the class to other classes or student organizations as permitted by the classroom assembly.

PROJECT MANAGER

a. They shall be responsible for all the business affairs of the classroom, such as canvassing and buying of supplies, etc. with coordination of the president and the vice president.

## ARTICLE X
## LEGISLATIVE DEPARTMENT

***SECTION 1.*** The legislative authority shall be vested upon the ELITE Officers and the class presidents of every section.

***SECTION 2.*** The ELITE president will act as the presiding speaker in all legislative assemblies. If the ELITE president is unavailable, the vice president will assume the role of speaker depending on the topic under discussion.

***SECTION 3.*** The bill to be passed, subject to a majority vote, must align with the welfare of the students as outlined in the student handbook, which has been duly signed by all ELITE officers, class presidents, and the ELITE adviser.

## ARTICLE XI
## FINANCES

***SECTION 1.*** Funds shall not be withdrawn from the treasury unless authorized by appropriations specified in the constitution.

***SECTION 2.*** The authority to prepare the organization's budget lies with the ELITE president, who is mandated by the constitution to draft the budget using current and proposed revenue measures. Subsequently, the budget is submitted to the school administration or the school director for approval.

***SECTION 3.*** The president, supported by the ELITE, holds the main responsibility for the organization's program. Ttheir entails making program and policy decisions to formulate the organizational budget.

***SECTION 4.*** The budget serves not only to establish priorities but also to translate them into operational terms. It begins by addressing the needs and enhancing the quality of the school for the PUPian community.

Budget Process applied in ELITE:

1. BUDGET PREPARATION

- The budget of the organization shall be prepared on the basis of budgetary proposals. It involves the establishment of the performance objectives within specified guides and limits of the university and the estimation of the amount of resources required to carry out the plan.
- These proposals are discussed by the ELITE officers before submission to the school administration or the school director for approval.

2. BUDGET AUTHORIZATION

- Ttheir involves the detailed review of the proposals in accordance with the rules of the university. The review will be made by the school administration or school director.
- If considered desirable, the proposals will be approved and authorized for budget release.

3. BUDGET EXECUTION

- At this stage, a fixed plan for the appropriated funds was adopted and budgetary controls were put in force to direct and limit the spending of funds according to the plan.
- The approved proposal, together with the corresponding resolution will be submitted to the treasury office or any officer that is authorized to release organizational funds of the university, for release of the budget.
- In receiving the cash budget, the treasurer must have a receiving copy of the resolution signed by the authorized budget officer as evidence of the said transaction.
- Control over expenditures is exercised by the president. In their function, he is assisted by the auditor and treasurer as provided by the constitution. It is at this point that budgeting serves as one of the principal tools of management.
- To secure planned performance through the sound of used resources, the treasurer releases funds by the organization's approved work and financial plan securing all the receipts gathered in all the transactions they will incur. As a result, unauthorized and excessive expenditures are avoided.

4. BUDGET ACCOUNTABILITY

- This stage is concerned with reporting the actual performance against the planned performance.
- More specifically, it consists of the preparation and submission of the following requirements:

➢ Financial reports for operation
➢ Actual cash disbursement receipts. These include the e-receipts using online banking or e-wallet.

# ARTICLE XII
# AMENDMENTS AND REVISIONS

***SECTION 1.*** Any amendments to or revision of their constitution may be proposed by:

a. The legislature (the ELITE officers and all the class representatives), upon a vote of three-fourths (3/4) of all its members; or
b. A constitutional convention.

***SECTION 2.*** Amendments to their constitution may also be proposed directly by students through initiative by submitting a petition.

# ARTICLE XIII
# ELITE COMMITTEES

***SECTION 1.*** The following list shall be used to fulfill the duties and responsibilities of ELITE: (The chairman of each committee may be appointed by the ELITE president or by the legislative board. The chairman of each committee may appoint its members. The executive officers may also be a chairman of a committee.)

a. Creatives Committee
- In charge of creating pubmats and posters.
- In charge of posting announcements to the organization's official social media accounts.

b. Multimedia Committee
- In charge of documentation,capturing pictures and videos of the events and activities that the organization is facilitating or participating in.

c. Programs Committee
- In charge of all the outside and inside university events in terms of technical. logistics, and manpower.

d. Sports Committee
- In charge of organizing and facilitating tryouts for the sports events that the organization will be participating in.
- Appoints heads for each sports category(basketball, volleyball, badminton, etc…)

e. ITDS
- The official dance group of ELITE.

f. CHACHEN
- The official band of ELITE

**Acknowledged by:**

**Camille Anne A. Bermejo**
*Executive President*

**Merryldine G. Parakikay**
*Vice President Internal*

**Maria Kathrina G. Hernandez**
*Vice President External*

**Austine Mark M. Espiritu**
*Executive Secretary*

**Eurika Angela Y. Bialen**
*Deputy Secretary*

**Carl Ste phen H. Garcia**
*Executive Treasurer*

**Pauline Faustina S. Panganiban**
*Assistant Treasurer*

**Julia Louisse M. Del Mundo**
*Auditor*

**Jheg S. Ardales**
*Public InformantOfficer*

**Daniel Angelo Aldueza**
*Project Manager*

**Joshua C. Africa**
*Project Manager*

**Noted by:**

**(sgd.) Mr. Dominic L. Fernandez**
*Organization Adviser, ELITE*

**(sgd.) Mr. Owen Harvey Balocon**
*Organization Adviser, ELITE*

**(sgd.) Engr. Emy Lou G. Alinsod**
*Head, Student Services*

**(sgd.) Dr. Leny V. Salmingo**
*Director*